

helping them find solid, well-performing companies to invest in. But over time, Bud began turning his attention to land development. Real estate was booming, and he figured he could make a lot more money—and make it faster.

Against Sandi's counsel, he borrowed sizable amounts of money from a local bank and invested it in what seemed to her to be risky real estate ventures. He even took on potential liabilities as a managing partner in several investments with others in the firm—again over his wife's vehement objections. With dollar signs in his eyes, Bud simply dismissed her concerns. Sandi felt like she had been relegated to the position of a child instead of an adult partner in the family's financial matters, and she resented it.

Things went fine for a while. Then one of the land investments in which Bud was a managing partner went sour. Everyone involved lost a great deal of money. One major investor accused Bud of mismanagement and filed a lawsuit against him. The suit called for the return of the money the investor had entrusted to Bud.

"You brought this on yourself," Sandi said as she looked at a copy of the lawsuit.

"Please, not now, Sandi," Bud pleaded, as he lowered his head into his hands. "I'm feeling really beaten down right now. I guess you don't understand."

"Sure, I understand. Your good friends have decided to let you hold the bag for the entire firm," Sandi said with an accusing tone. "I told you not to do business with Jerry Groves. There was something about him I didn't like the first time I met him."

"Oh, spare me the sermon," Bud growled. "This has to be the 999th time you've said that. It's always, 'You never take my advice,' and 'You never listen to me.' Sandi, this is serious. Don't you realize how much trouble this can cause me?"

"Can cause *us*, Bud. How much trouble it can cause *us*. That's our main trouble now: You think you're in it alone if it is a financial decision."